Syntax(002) Midterm

강초롱

2025 Fall

1. Consider the following data taken from Turkish (3 points)

(1) Siz **gid**-iyor.sun.uz.
you.PL go-PRES.2.PL
'You are going.'

(2) Ali üç yeşil top **al**-dı.
Ali three green ball buy-PST.3SG
'Ali bought three green balls.'

(3) Senin sınavı **geç**-meni **isti**-yorum.
you test pass-INF want-PRES.1SG
'I want you should pass the test.'[1]

a. In the data, PRES means "present tense", PST means "past tense". What part of speech are **'gid'**, **'al'**, **'geç'**, and **'isti'**? What tests did you use to figure out what speech they were?

verb.
because they all have suffixes like tense suffix and infinitive suffix, which verbs can have.

b. Provide the PSRs needed to generate the trees
(assume that every clause is a CP, and *üç* "three" is an adjective).

CP → (C) TP
TP → (NP) (T) VP
VP → NP/CP V
NP → (AdjP+) N
AdjP → Adj

[1] the matrix verb agrees with the silent matrix subject.

2. Consider the following sentence

The teacher saw that her students fought constantly after school in the parking lot.

a. For the following words, indicate their part of speech *AND*

(i) if the word is an open class part of speech, explain the (morphological/syntactic) distributional criteria by which you came up with that classification.

(ii) if the word is closed part of speech, indicate it with "closed".

(iii) Mark whether each word is a lexical or functional part of speech. (4 points)

The Determiner, closed, functional

Teacher Noun, open, lexical / becuase it has noun suffix '-er'

Saw Verb, open, lexical / because it appears after the subject.

That Complementizer, closed, functional

Her Determiner, closed, functional

Constantly Adverb, open, lexical / because it has adverb suffix '-ly'

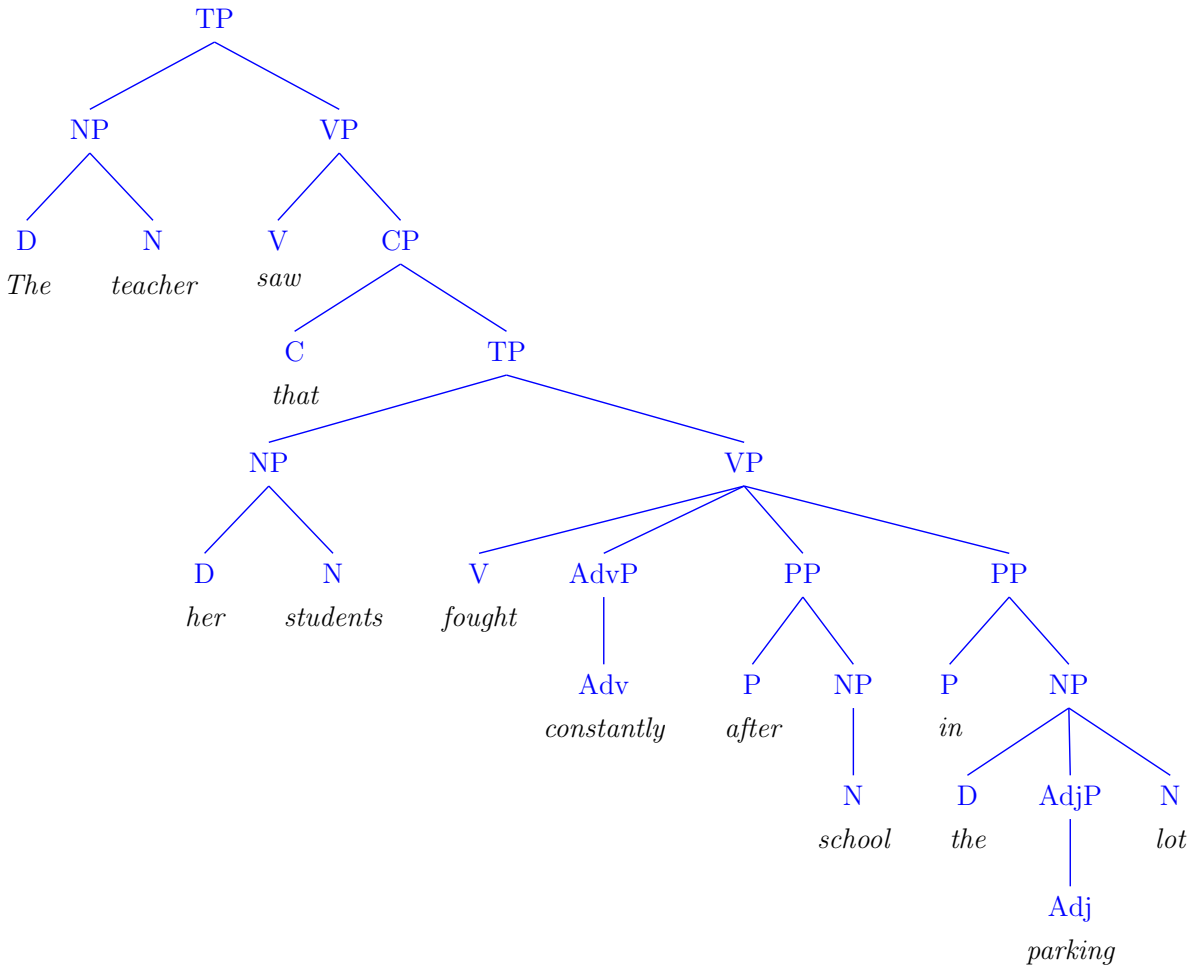
After Preposition, closed, functional

Parking Adjective, open, lexical / because it has adjective suffix '-ing' and modifies the following noun 'lot' [2]

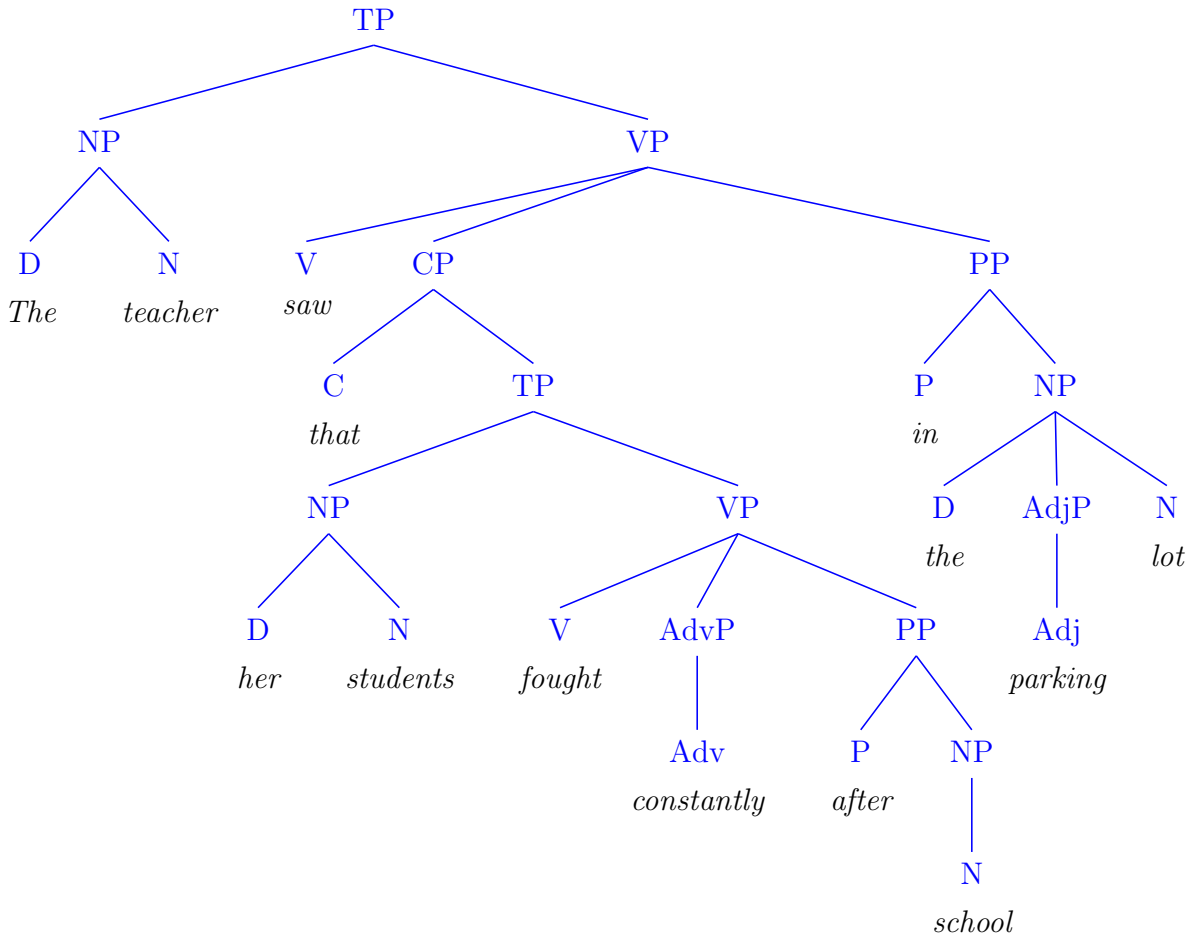
[2] it also can be considered as a noun.

b. The above sentence is ambiguous (assume that the ambiguity comes from the phrase "in the parkng lot"). Draw the two PSR trees that distinguish the two possible meanings of the sentence. Provide a Korean paraphrase for each meaning. (2 points)

(1) 학생들이 주차장에서 싸우는 것을 선생님이 보았다.

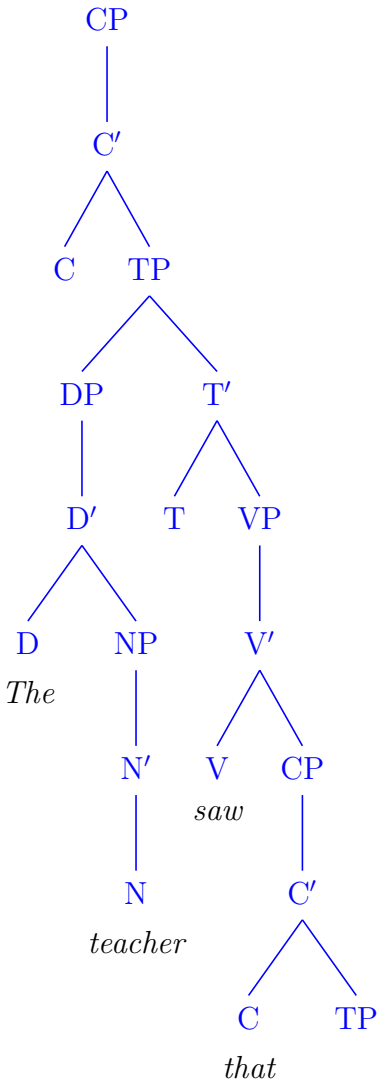


(2) 학생들이 싸우는 것을 선생님이 주차장에서 보았다.

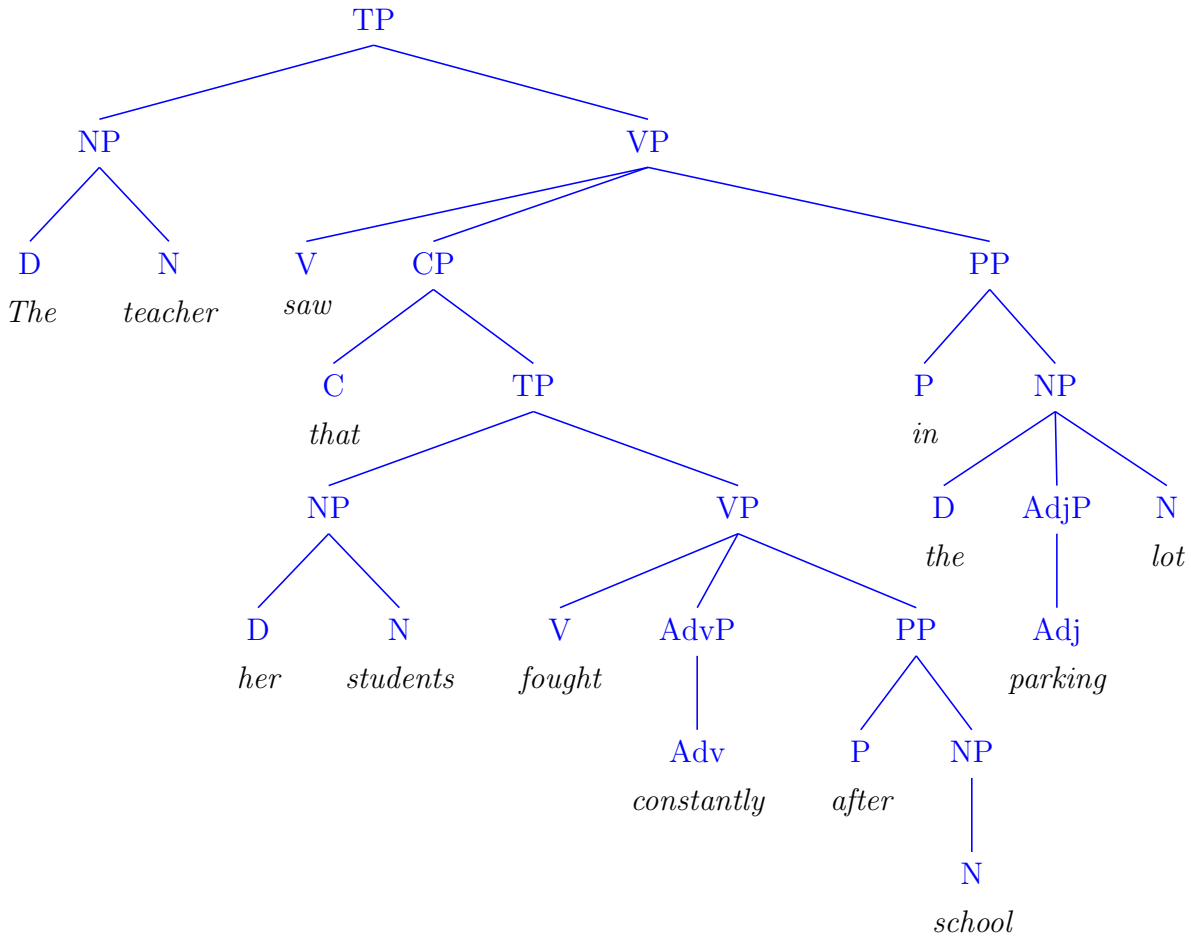


c. Draw the two X-bar theoretic trees that distinguish the two possible meanings of the sentence. Provide a Korean paraphrase for each meaning. (2 points)

(1) 학생들이 주차장에서 싸우는 것을 선생님이 보았다.



(2) 학생들이 싸우는 것을 선생님이 주차장에서 보았다.



d. Answer the following questions (6 points)

(i) Can the two theories (PSRs and X-bar theory) explain the ambiguity? If so, explain why. You must refer to the tree structures you provided above in your answer.

(ii) In the slightly modified sentence below, the interpretation in which *the parents fought after school at the park and the teacher saw it* is available. Can both theories account for this reading?

The teacher saw that her students fought constantly after school in the parking lot. She saw that their parents did so at the park as well.

(iii) Explain why (a) is ungrammatical but (b) is grammatical, referring to the rules of X-bar theory.

(a) The teacher saw **the fight** that her students fought constantly after school in the parking lot.

(b) The teacher saw that her students fought constantly after school in the parking lot **every day**.

3. Consider the following data from Breton, a Celtic language. **(7 points)**

(1) ar baner c'hlas
the basket blue
'the blue basket'

(2) ar vleunienn wenn
the flower white
'the white flower'

(3) Kador ar bugel bihan
Chair the child small
'The small child's chair'

(4) Me a-zebr pesked alies
I eat fish often
'I often eat fish'

i. What is the setting of the specifier parameter?

ii. What is the setting of the adjunct parameter?

iii. What is the setting of the complement parameter?

iv. Draw the X-bar theoretic tree for (d) and answer the following questions.

(a) What node(s) does the VP dominate?

(b) What node(s) does the V head govern?

(c) What node(s) immediately precedes AdvP?

(d) List all the nodes that asymmetrically c-command DP *fish*?

(e) What node(s) does the TP exhaustively dominate?

(f) What node(s) does the subject DP phrase govern?

4. Draw the X-bar theoretic tree for the following sentence and explain why the acceptability of the following sentence challenges the binding theory we discussed in class. (3 points)

John's father$_i$ saw a snake near him/himself$_i$.

5. Draw the X-bar theoretic tree for the following sentence, and determine whether the matrix clause and the embedded clause are finite or non-finite. You must provide evidence for your answer. **(3 points)**

I asked him to leave.